

79% of millionaires received no inheritance at all from their parents.

So, what's the secret for these first-generation millionaires, then? Well, the research shows us that it's the opposite of a silver-spoon, family-handout mentality. It's the can-do work ethic they learned from their parents. Eight out of ten millionaires come from families at or below the middle-class income level. When we break that down, 48%—so almost half of all millionaires—described their parents' household as middle class, 27% described it as lower-middle class, and 4.25% of them described it as lower class. It seems that real millionaires aren't waiting around for someone else to hand them a fortune. Instead, they put their head down and get to work with fierce determination, focusing their energies on long-term goals. *That*—not Mom and Dad's money—is how they build wealth and declare their own financial independence. And this reality should empower you to know that, yes, you too can reach millionaire status.